

“Exam Stress and its Impact on Academic Performance”

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ABSTRACT

This study investigates the link between examination stress and academic performance among 109 students. Exam stress was measured using a standardized Likert-scale questionnaire, while academic performance was assessed through recent exam scores. Most students reported experiencing exam stress, primarily due to lack of preparation time (42.2%) and poor time management (21.1%). Other contributing factors included peer competition (13.8%), health issues (11%), and financial difficulties (5.5%), with 6.4% citing other causes. The findings show that exam stress is widespread and impacts students' academic outcomes. The study recommends interventions such as relaxation techniques, counseling, and structured study planning to help manage stress and improve performance.

INTRODUCTION

Exam stress refers to the anxiety or pressure students feel while preparing for or taking exams, tests, assignments, or presentations. Some stress can be helpful, as it encourages students to prepare and stay focused. However, too much stress can make it difficult to concentrate, learn, and perform well academically. Studies show that exam periods, especially oral exams, can be very stressful, causing worry, anxiety, sleep problems, forgetfulness, irritability, fatigue, and a sense of being overwhelmed.

OBJECTIVE

Identify the causes of exam stress, including performance pressure, fear of failure.

Analyze the occurrence and degree of stress faced by learners during exams.

Investigate how examination stress influences academic performance.

Explore coping strategies used by students, such as time management, relaxation, or counseling.

Key Findings

Demographics: Majority male (51.4%), postgraduates (27.5%), mainly from Science (43.1%) and private institutions (72.5%).

Major Stressors: Main causes were lack of preparation time (42.2%) and poor time management (21.1%); 36.7% sometimes feared failure.

CONCLUSION

The study confirms that exam stress significantly impacts students' academic performance, emotional well-being, and overall health. Lack of preparation time, fear of failure, and parental/societal expectations are the primary stressors. While many students adopt coping strategies such as time management and group study, institutional support remains insufficient, with limited access to counseling or structured stress management programs.

FUTURE SCOPE

Future research should involve a larger and more diverse group of students to improve reliability. It should also compare differences between government and private institutions as well as across various academic streams. Using standardized psychological tools can enhance the accuracy of findings, while long-term studies can provide deeper insights into stress patterns over time. Additionally, the effectiveness of counseling services and stress management programs should be evaluated. There is also scope for developing mobile-based tools to help students manage stress. Increasing awareness about mental health is essential, and future studies should also consider the perspectives of teachers and parents for a more comprehensive understanding.

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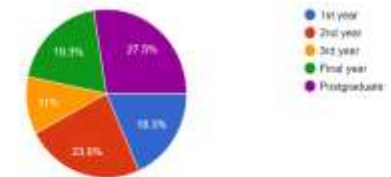
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FEEDBACK

Academic Year
109 responses



Field of Study
109 responses



Which of the following cause you stress during exams?
109 responses

